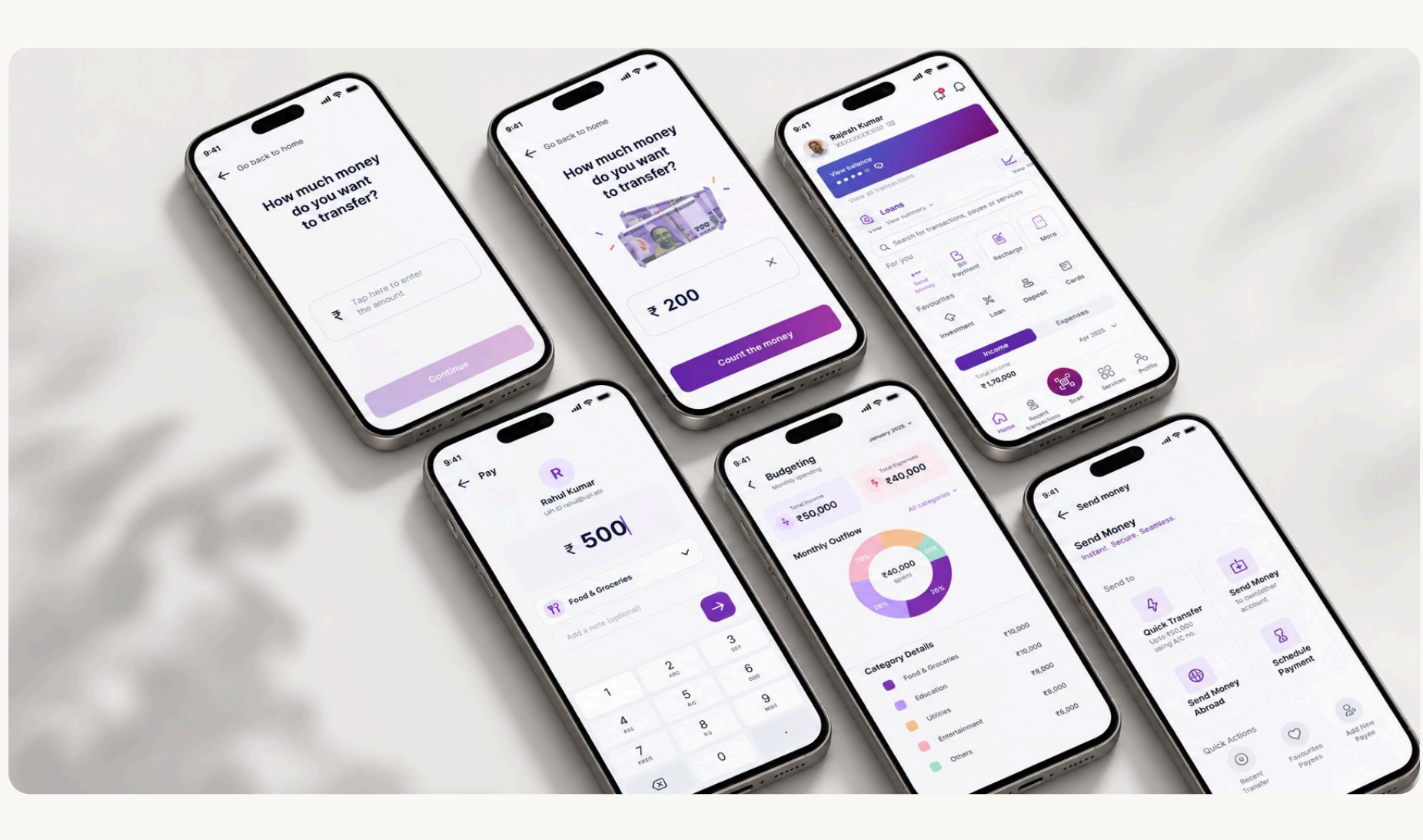
Making YONO SBI Easier for Different Kinds of Users

Redesigning core banking experiences for different users, and their different needs.

My Role
UX Research, Usability testing, UI Design

Team
Aradhika & Khushboo

Tools Used
Moderated Testing, Think aloud method, 5s test, card sorting, A/B Testing



Testing YONO SBI with six different users.

We tested the YONO SBI app with 6 users to understand how familiarity, banking experience and digital confidence shaped their experience. the study focused on checking balance, transactions, sending money, and adding payee.

Tested with:

Regular YONO user
Familiar with the app and everyday banking tasks

SBI user, but new to YONO
Familiar with SBI banking, but new to its mobile app

First time YONO user
Helpful until they get used to it

Young digital user
Used to quick UPI experiences and other digital payment apps.

Occasional user
Uses the app infrequently

Senior user
Rarely uses YONO independently

Pain points

1. **Different users had different needs**
Regular users wanted transaction and bill payments, while young users wanted budgeting and spending alert

2. **No personalization**
The same experience was shown to users with different needs and priorities

3. **Frequent actions were harder to reach**
Most used actions were not easily accessible

4. **Low error prevention**
Network issue created fear of failed or duplicate payments, especially in senior users

Participants

01 Regular User Of Yono
Prathmesh Waliokar
Age 35-40,
Architect and Professor

02 Account Holder (Non-YONO User)
Rajat Akre
Age 35-40,
Professor + UI/UX Designer

03 First time User Of Yono
Sheela Patil
Age 45-50,
Housewife

04 Non-SBI User
Hemchand Pavnikar
Age 21
College student

05 Occasional User
Ranjana Satpute
Age 40-50,
Housewife

06 Senior User
Rekha Ghorse
Age 60+,
Housewife

Tasks Tested

We tested three core banking tasks to understand how easily users could find, understand and complete everyday actions on YONO.

01 View Balance & Transactions
Users completed the task, but balance visibility and the eye icon were unclear, especially for first-time and senior users.

Task completion: **100%**
● Completed 10/10 users

Average time taken: **30 sec**

Error rate **10–20%**
0% 100%

Key issues observed
- Balance not immediately visible
- Eye icon unclear
- New users relied on scanning

02 Send Money
Similar options like UPI, Quick Transfer and Fund Transfer created confusion, wrong paths and unnecessary exploration.

Task completion: **85%**
● Completed 9/10 users
● Could not complete 1/10 users

Average time taken: **1 min**

Error rate **40–50%**
0% 100%

Key issues observed
- Confusion between UPI, Quick Transfer and Fund Transfer
- Wrong option selection
- Unnecessary exploration to find the right flow

03 Add Payee & Transfer
The longest and most difficult flow. Users faced input errors, unclear terminology, app-switching issues and uncertainty after adding a payee.

Task completion: **65%**
● Completed 6/10 users
● Could not complete 4/10 users

Average time taken: **2–3 min**

Error rate **55%**
0% 100%

Key issues observed
- Input errors during details entry
- Unclear terminology
- App-switching for OTP/verification
- Uncertainty after adding a payee

What did we Learn?

Important actions as per the individual, were hard to find
Core actions were available, but users often had to scan , search and explore to find them.

Confusing transaction labelings
Similar transfer options and unclear labels created hesitation and incorrect paths

Different uses needed different support
Experienced users moved faster, while 1st time occasional and senior users needed greater visibility

Some users wanted budgeting feature
users said they wanted something extra, other than banking services like budgeting feature to use that app frequently

Elderly users are less comfortable with online transfers.
as money is represented only through numbers.

Confirmation screen lacked information about cooling period
causing users to repeat the process unnecessarily.

User needs

1. **Easy access to frequent actions**
Users need their most used actions visible and easy

2. **Simplicity**
Want to see what matters to them without getting overwhelmed by unnecessary options

3. **Better money management**
3 out of 6 users mentioned that a budgeting feature would help them manage their money better

4. **Error prevention, especially during network issues**
Users need clear guidance before errors, and confirmation confirmation after transactio

Solution

Tag important action
Users can add tags like "Favourite" to actions they want quick access to

Simple home section
Showing only relevant options

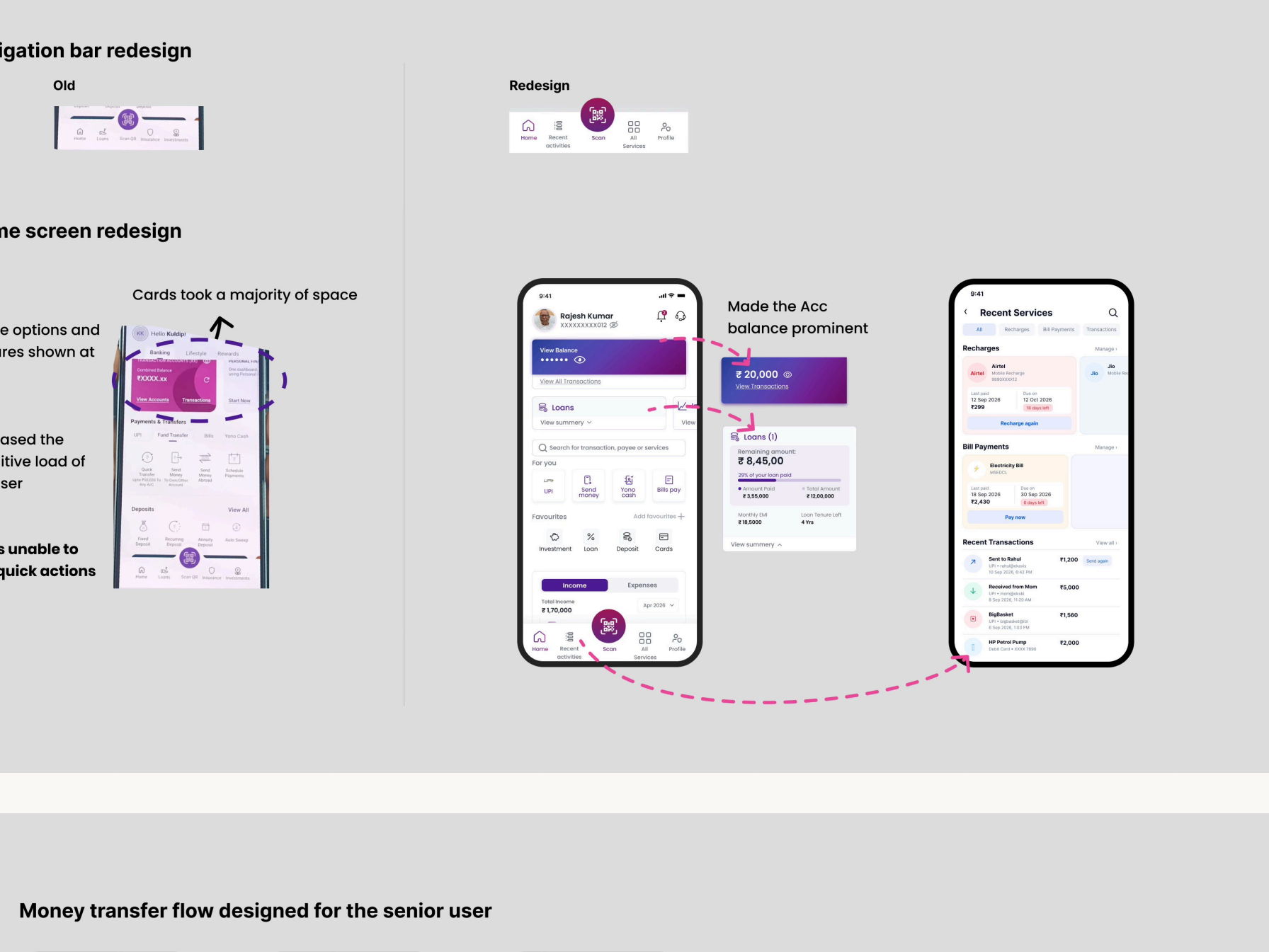
Frequently used tasks visible
Common actions automatically appear on the home screen

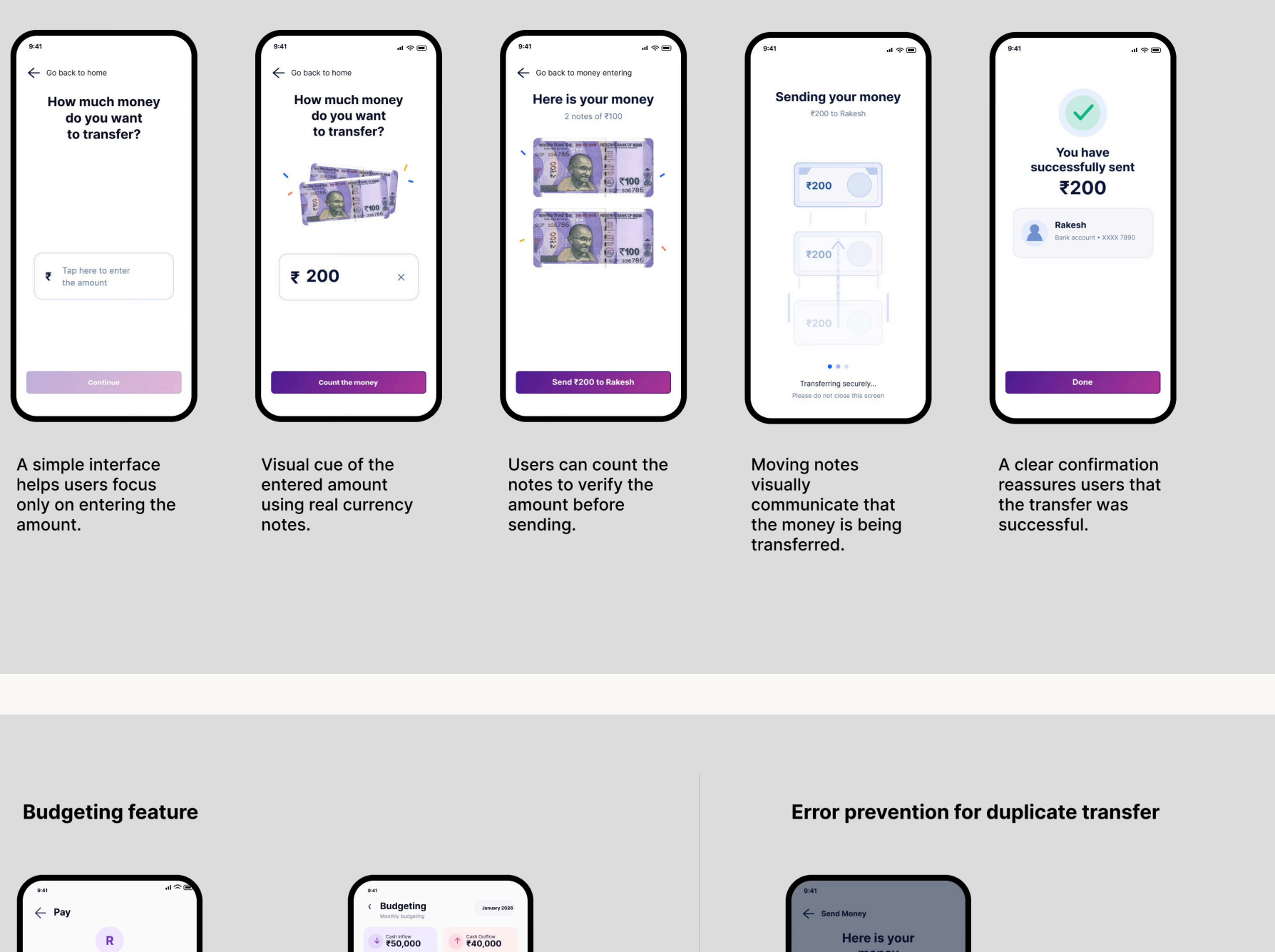
Budgeting and spending
A budgeting feature that helps spending and tracking of the money

Visualization of real notes while money tranfer
Shows money as familiar notes, making transfers easier to understand.

Warn users before duplicate transfers
A pop-up warning before an immediate transaction of a similar amount.

High-fidelity screens


Navigation bar redesign
Old
Redesign
Home screen redesign
Cards took a majority of space
All the options and features shown at once
Increased the cognitive load of the user
Users unable to find quick actions
Made the Acc balance prominent


Money transfer flow designed for the senior user

A simple interface helps users focus only on entering the amount.

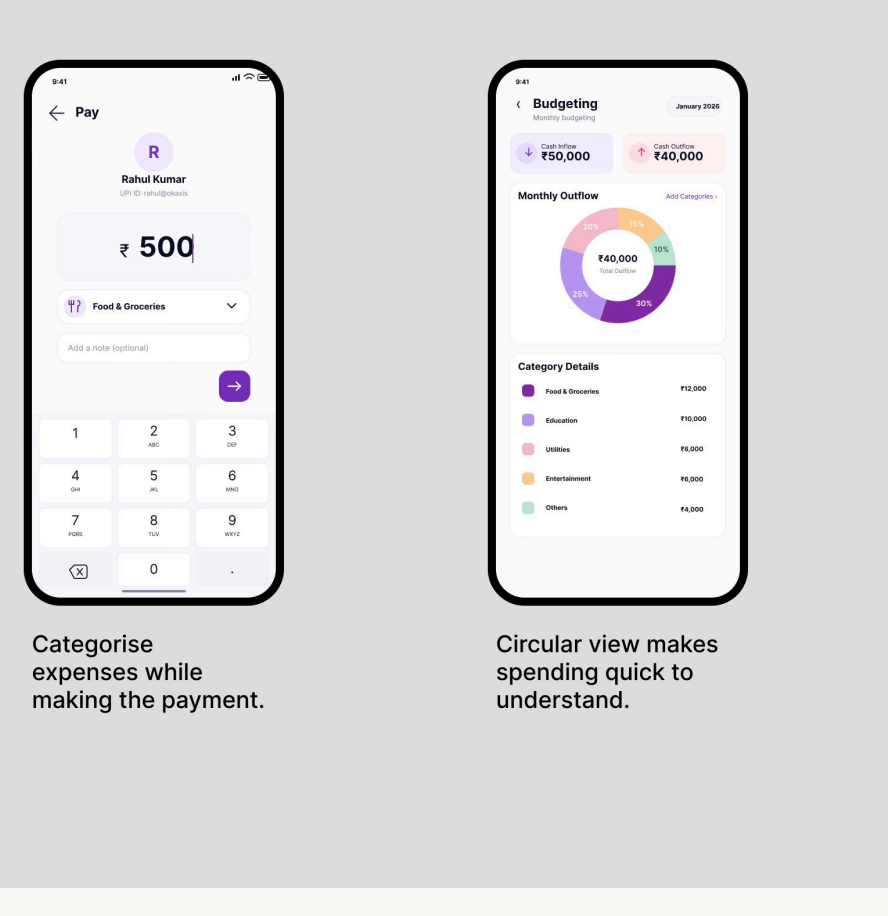
Visual cue of the entered amount using real currency notes.

Users can count the notes to verify the amount before sending.

Moving notes visually communicate that the money is being transferred.

A clear confirmation reassures users that the transfer was successful.

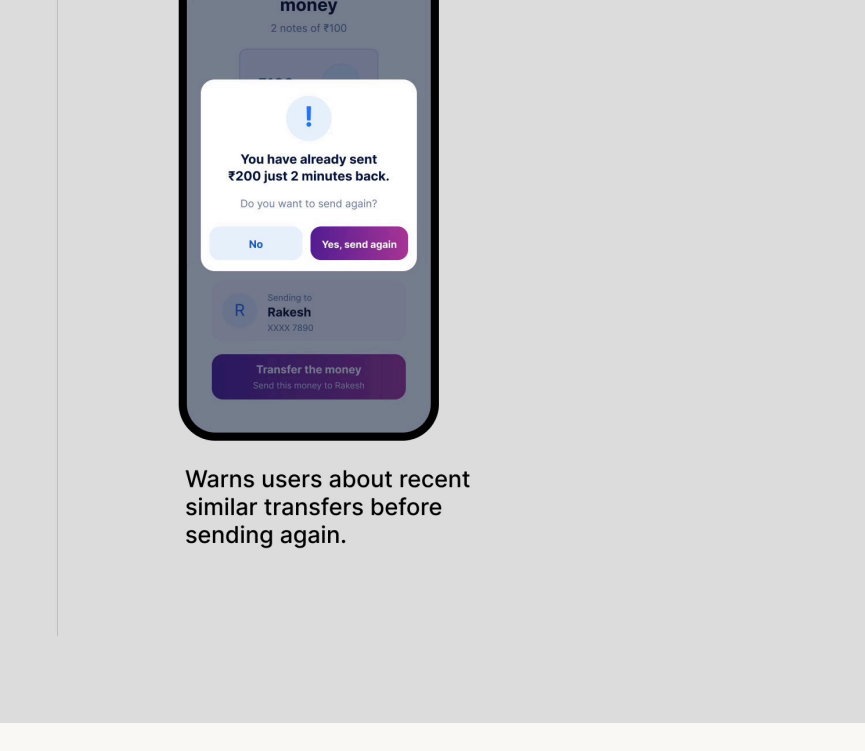
How much money do you want to transfer?
₹ 200
Here is your money
Sending your money
You have successfully sent ₹200
Done


Budgeting feature

Categorise expenses while making the payment.

Circular view makes spending quick to understand.

₹ 500
Budgeting

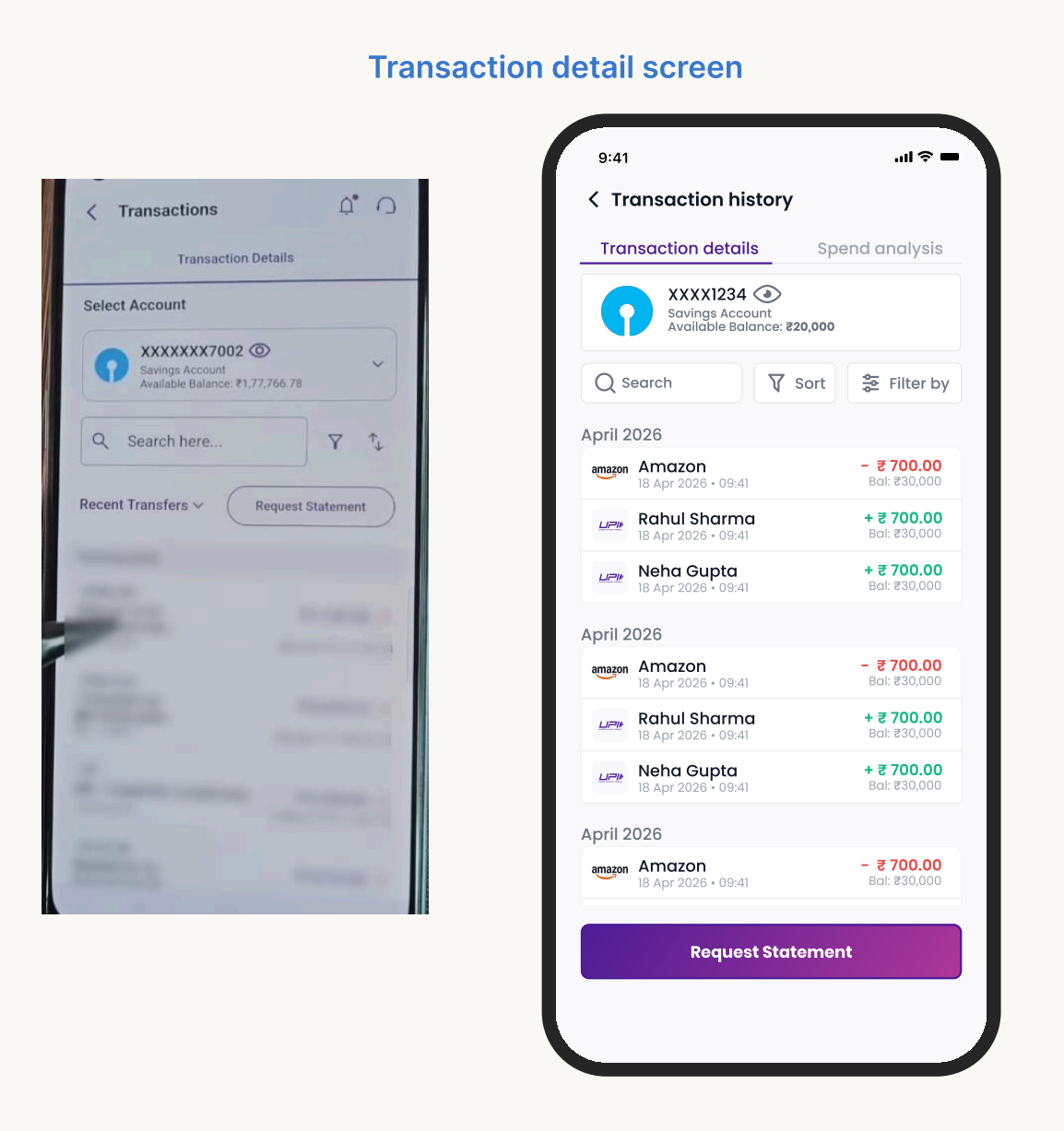

Error prevention for duplicate transfer

Warns users about recent similar transfers before sending again.

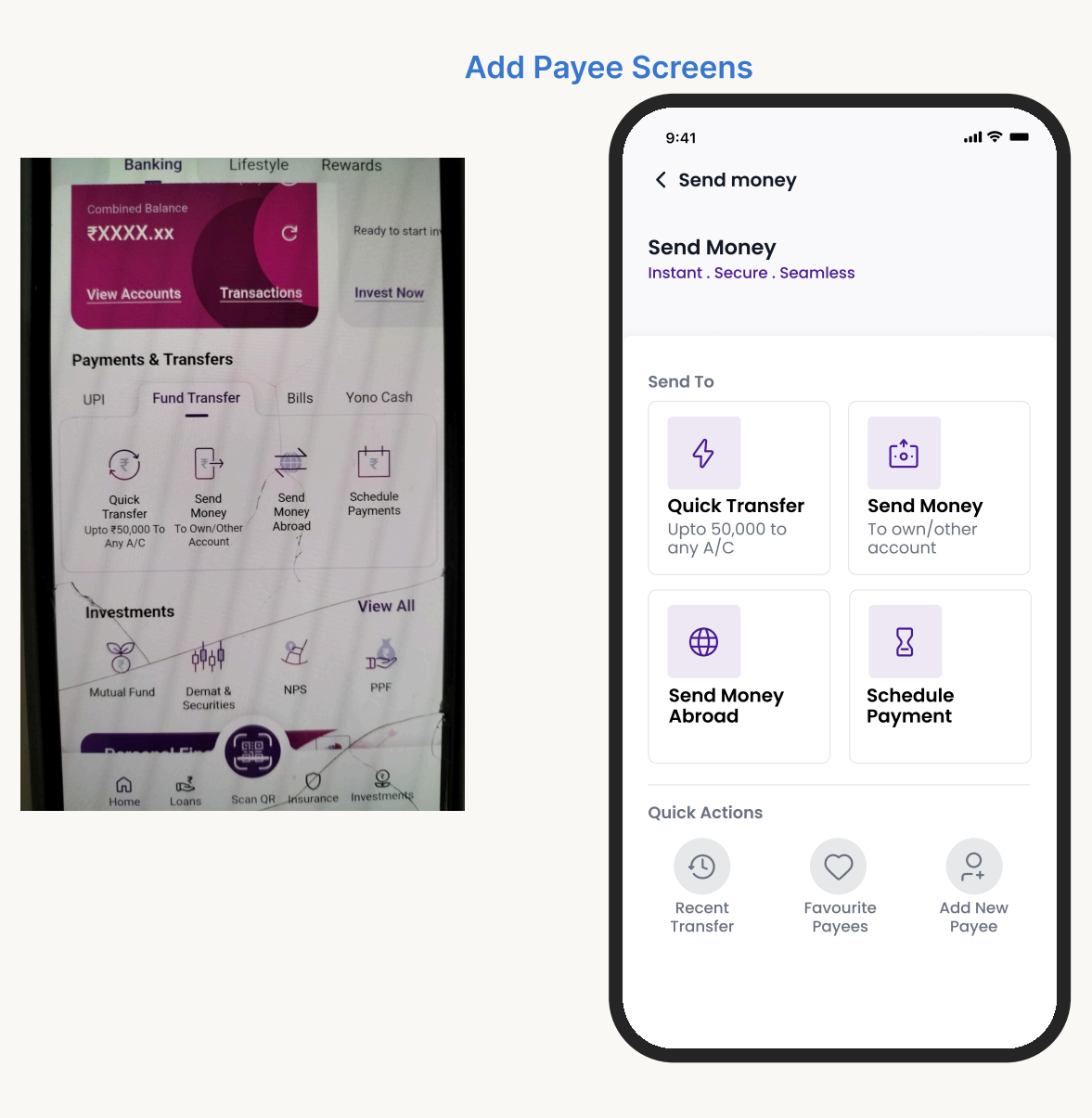
Here is your money
You have already sent ₹200 just 2 minutes back.

Tested flow refined

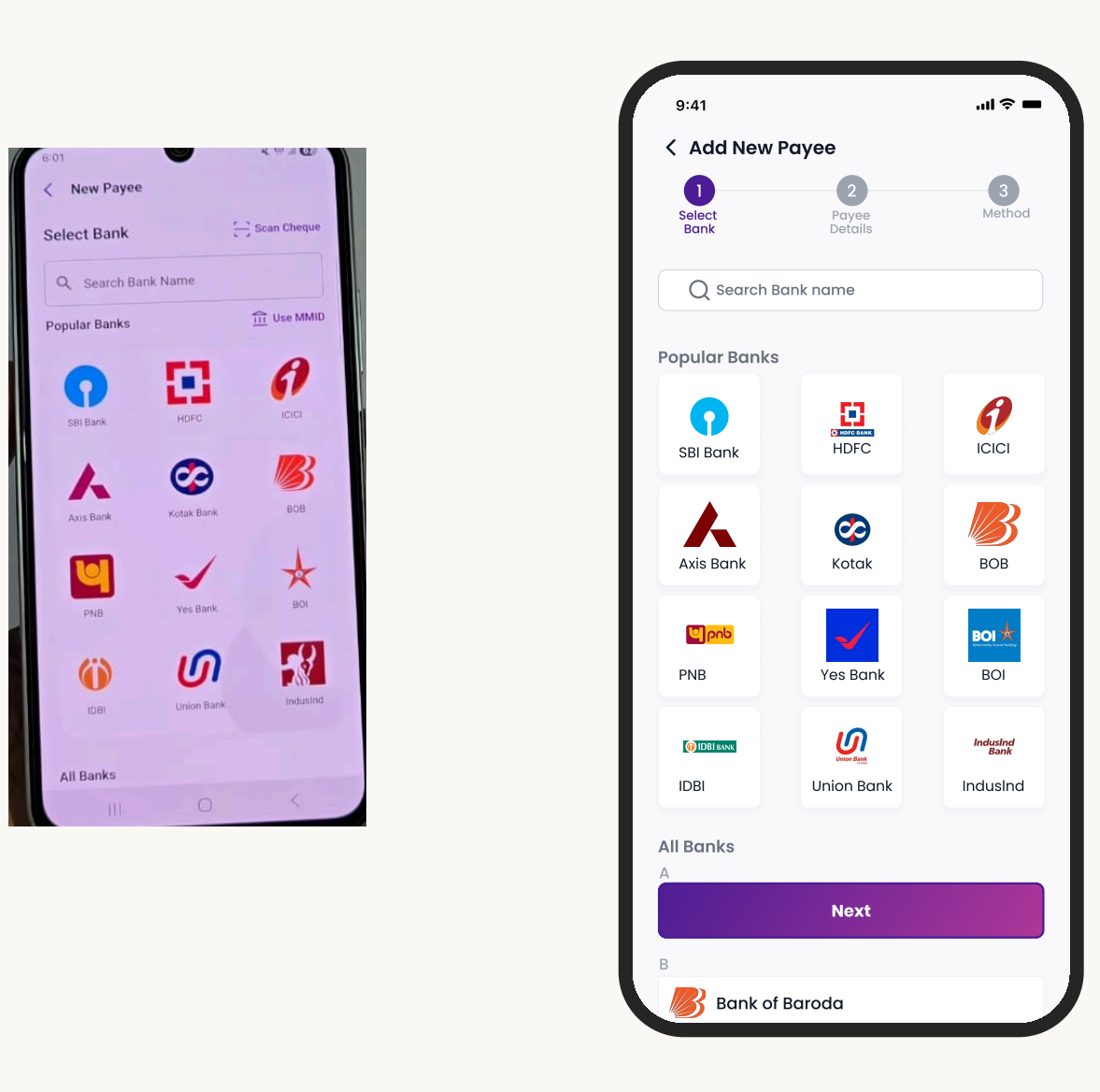
Transaction detail screen


Transactions
Transaction history
Transaction details
Spend analysis
XXXX1234
Search
Sort
Filter by
April 2026
Amazon
Rahul Sharma
Neha Gupta
Request Statement

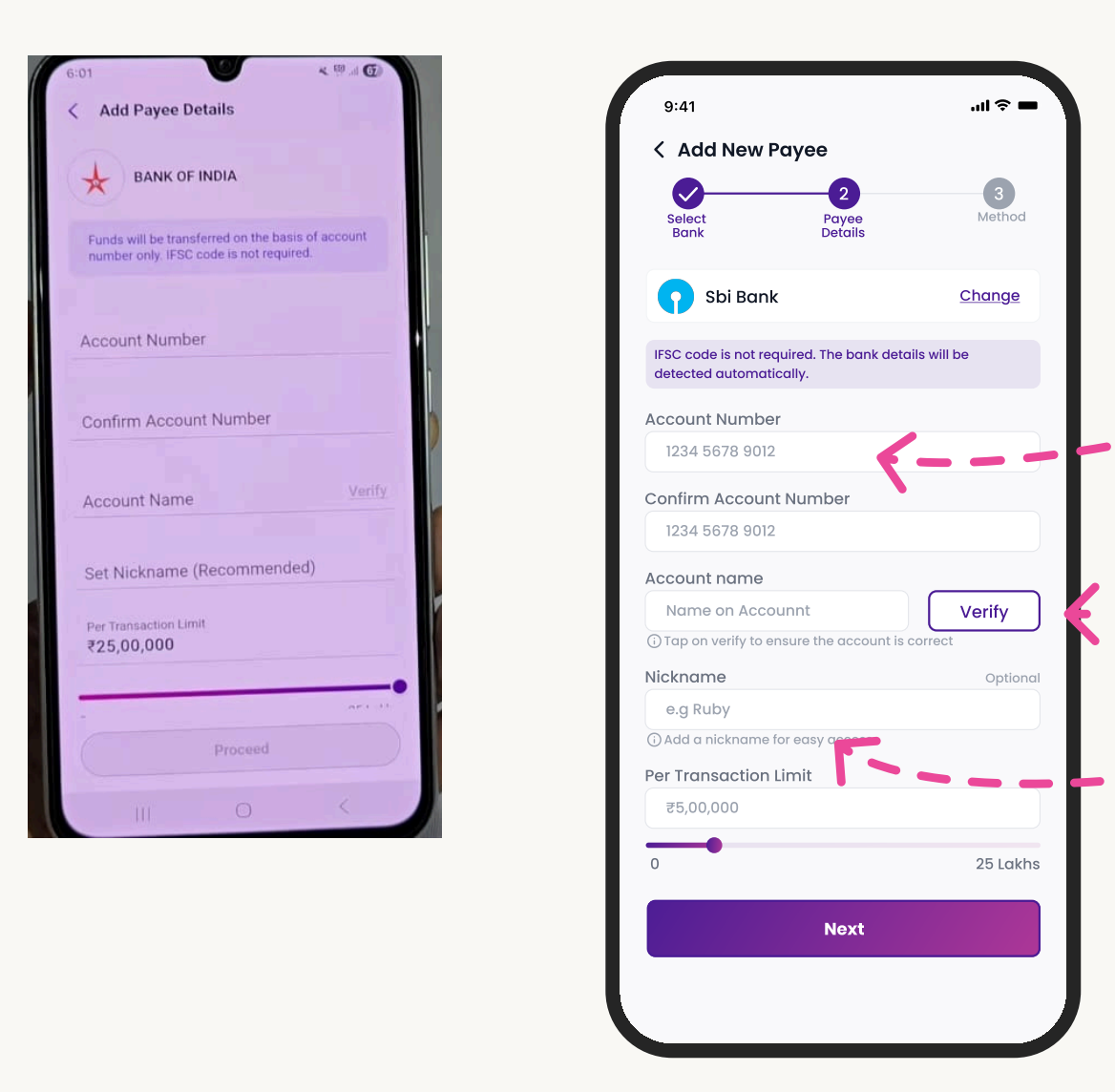
Add Payee Screens


Transfer related options are moved **into a separate section** to create a more focused and less overwhelming home screen.

Send money
Send Money
Instant . Secure . Seamless
Send To
Quick Transfer
Send Money
Send Money Abroad
Schedule Payment
Quick Actions
Recent Transfer
Favourite Payees
Add New Payee


Introduced a step based progress bar **to provide clear navigation**, indicate completion status, and reduce user uncertainty.

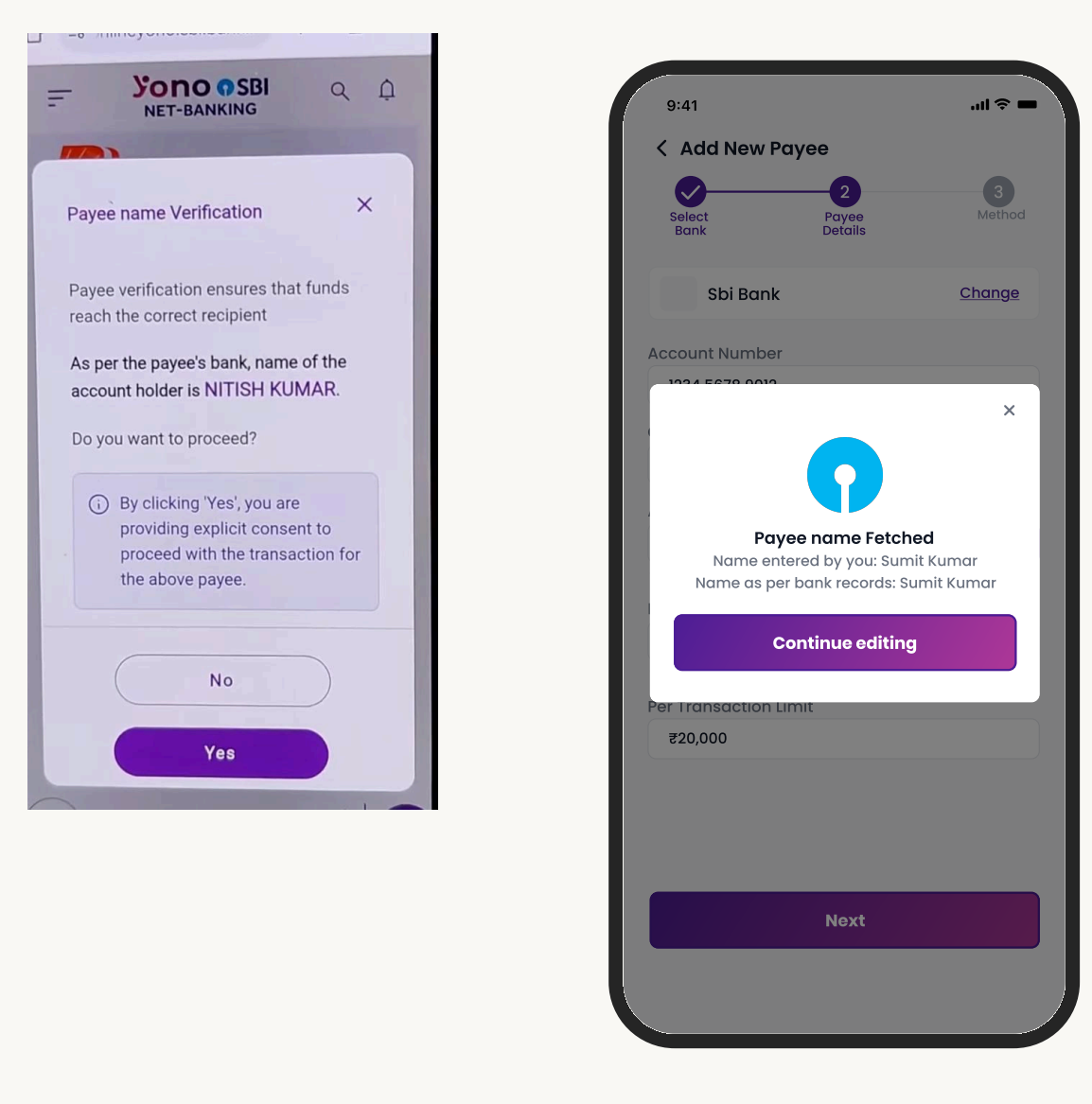
Add New Payee
Select Bank
Payee Details
Method
Search Bank name
Popular Banks
SBI Bank
HDFC
ICICI
Axis Bank
Kotak
BOB
PNB
Yes Bank
BOI
IDBI
Union Bank
Indusind
All Banks
Next
Bank of Baroda


Acc No: to be filled in chunks to, improve readability, reduce entry errors

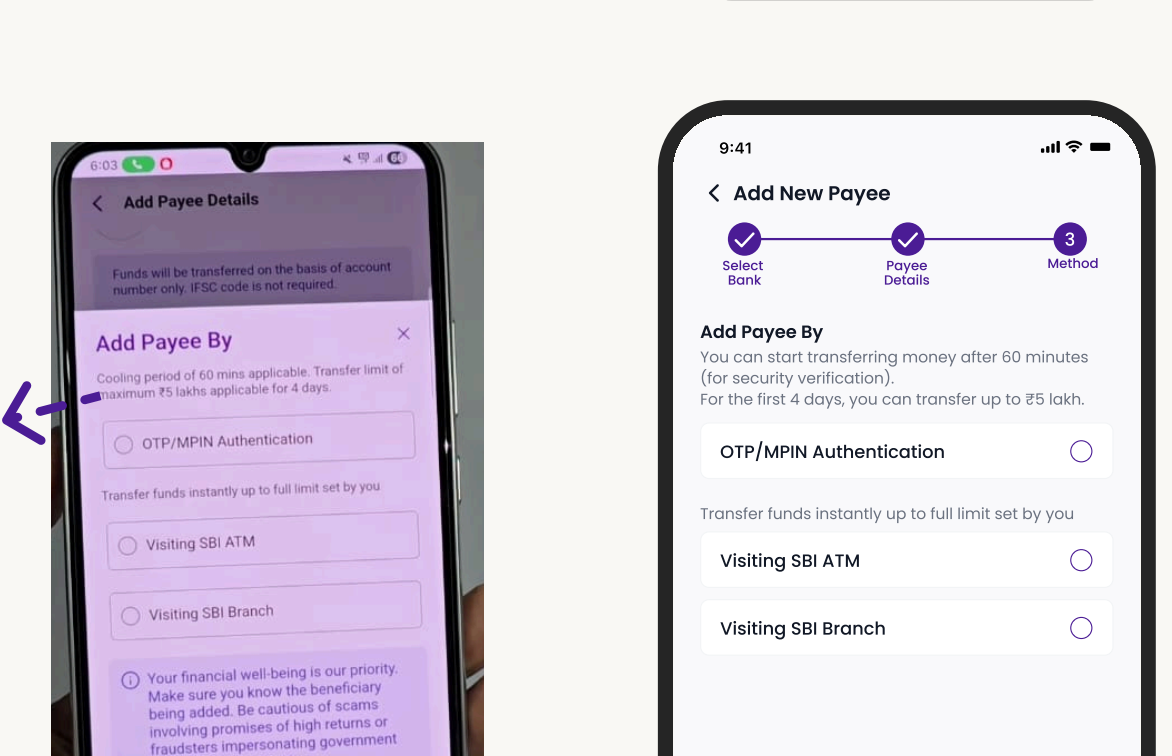
Made the "Verify" button prominent to improve visibility

Added contextual helper text to guide first time users on what action to take and why

Add New Payee
Sbi Bank
Change
Account Number
1234 5678 9012
Confirm Account Number
Account name
Verify
Nickname
Per Transaction Limit
₹5,00,000
0
25 Lakhs
Next


Simplified the verification screen by retaining only essential information

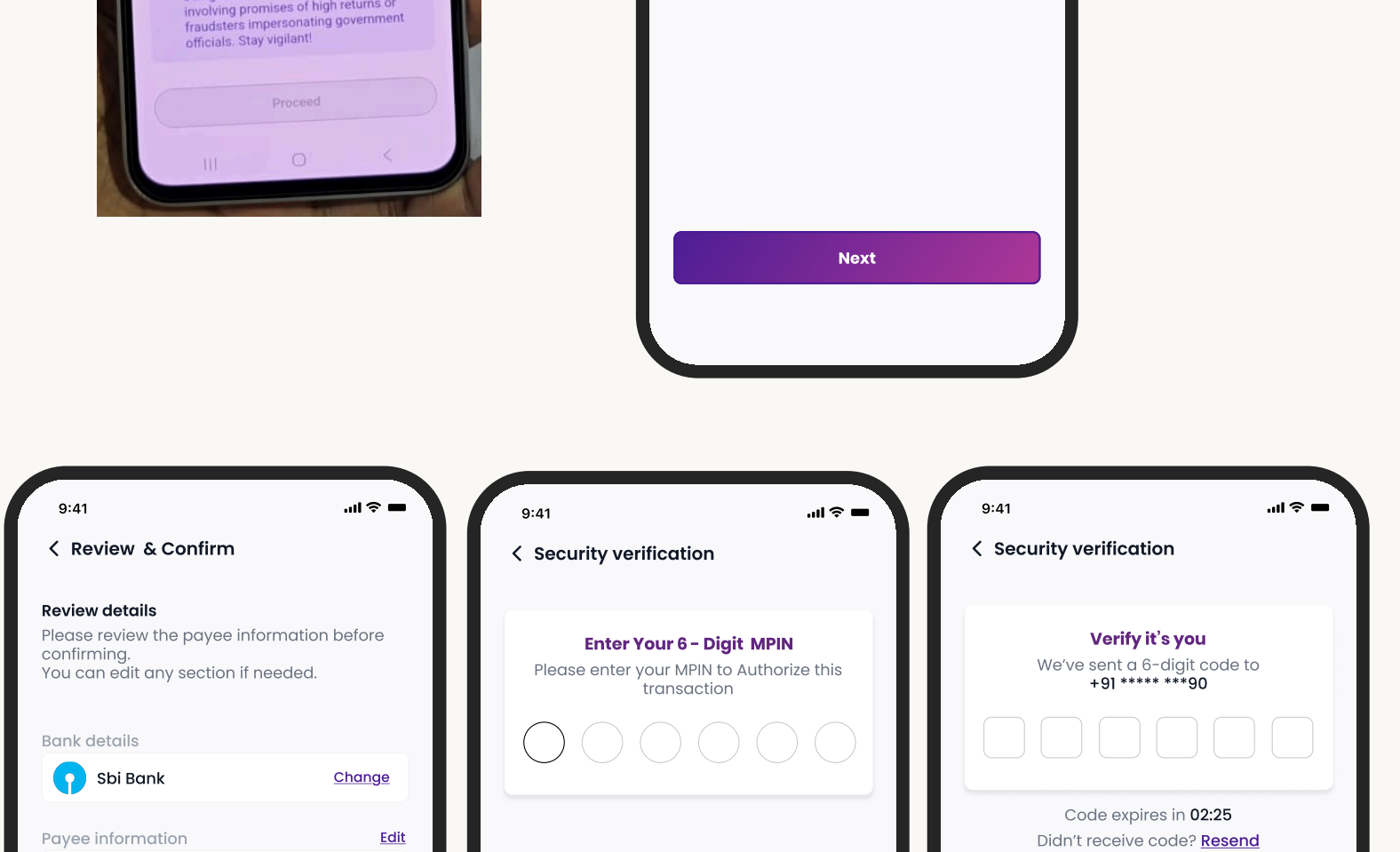
Payee name Verification
As per the payee's bank, name of the account holder is NITISH KUMAR
No
Yes
Payee name Fetched
Continue editing


The cooling period of 60 minutes often goes unnoticed,

And new users find the terminology difficult to understand.

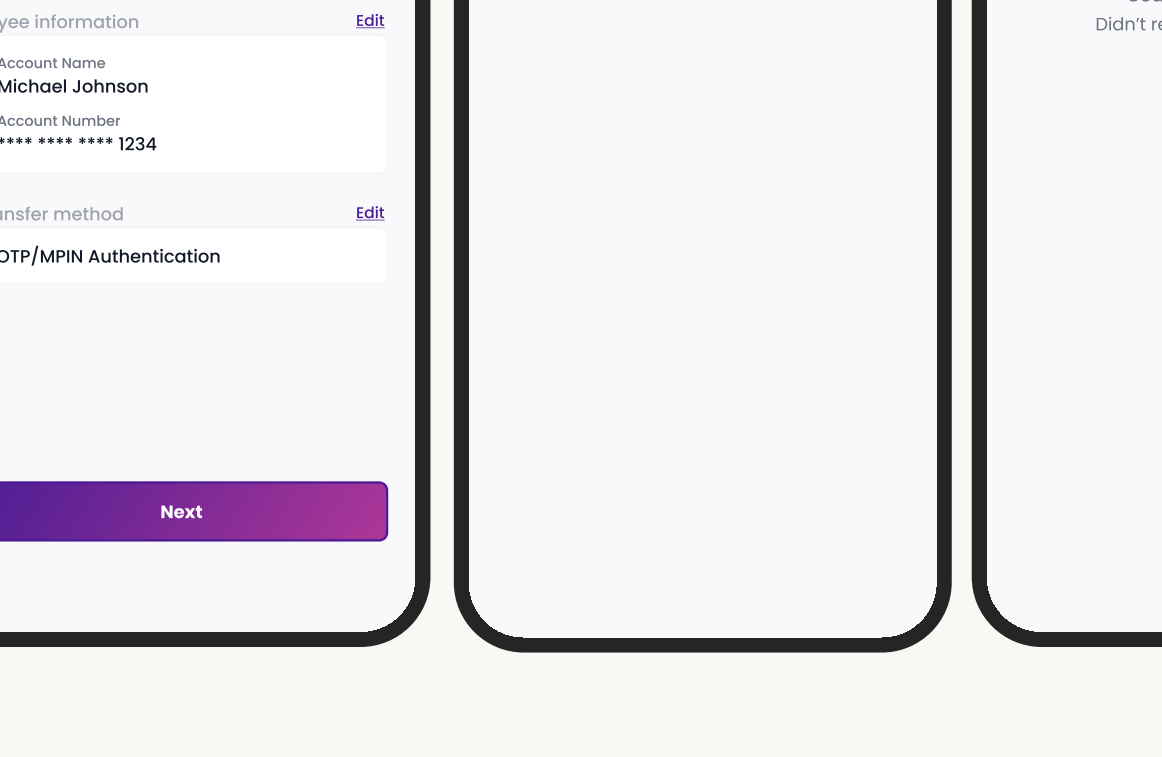
Simplified the Text

Add New Payee
Add Payee By
You can start transferring money after 60 minutes (for security verification).
For the first 4 days, you can transfer up to ₹5 lakh.
OTP/MPIN Authentication
Transfer funds instantly up to full limit set by you
Visiting SBI ATM
Visiting SBI Branch
Next


Absence of a review screen

Violated error prevention heuristics, as users were not given an opportunity to verify details before confirming the action.

Review & Confirm
Review details
Please review the payee information before confirming.
You can edit any section if needed.
Sbi Bank
Change
Payee information
Edit
Michael Johnson
**** **** **** 1234
Transfer method
OTP/MPIN Authentication
Next
Security verification
Enter Your 6 - Digit MPIN
Verify it's you
Code expires in 02:25
Didn't receive code? Resend


The success screen lacked clear communication about payee activation

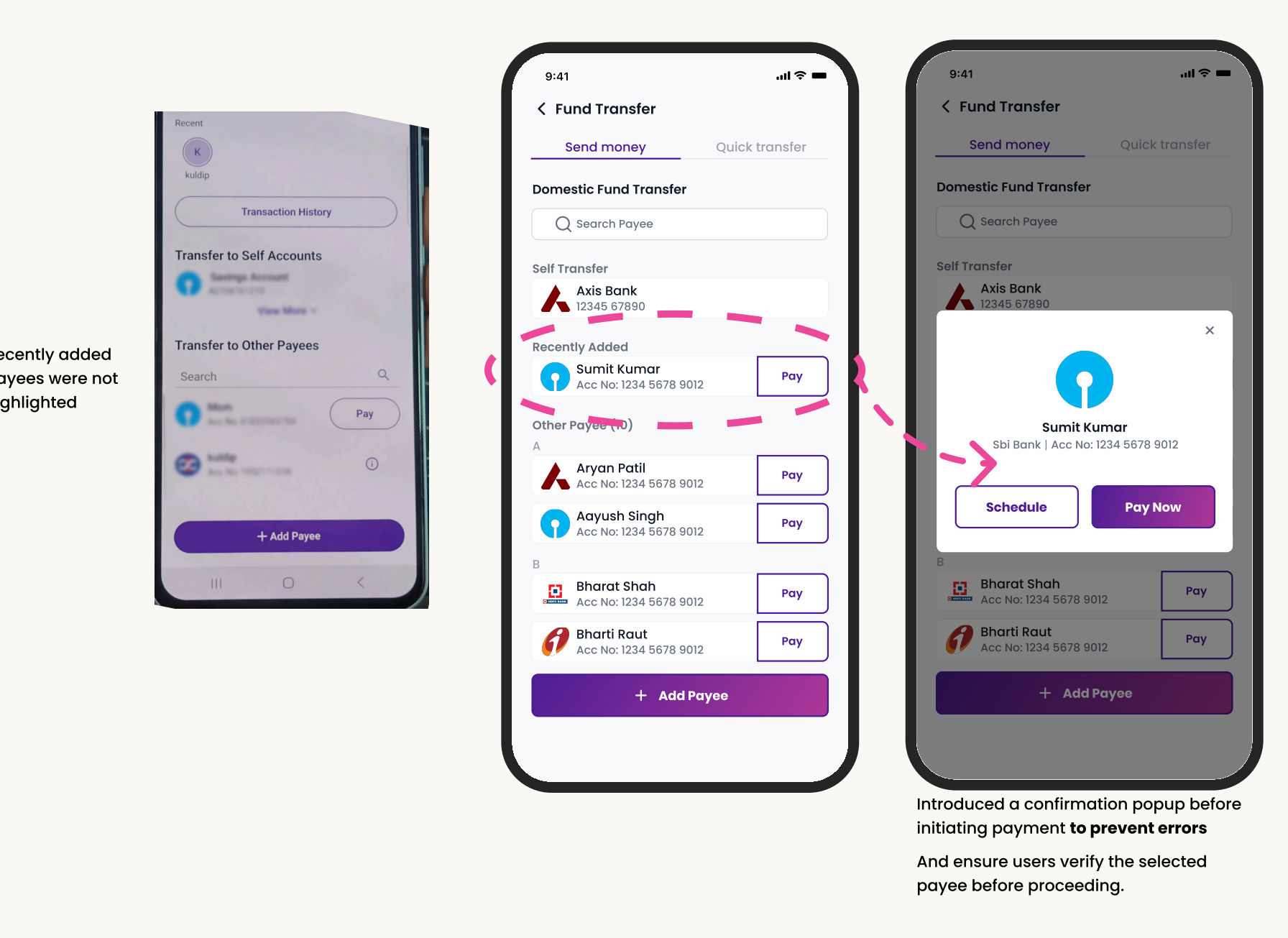
leading to user confusion after completing the process.

Introduced a popup overlay to highlight the payee activation message

ensuring visibility and reducing confusion, as the cooling period varies based on transaction limits.

Successfully Initiated!
Payee will be activated in 60 mins.
You will be able to transfer money once the activation is complete
Quick Transfer
Home

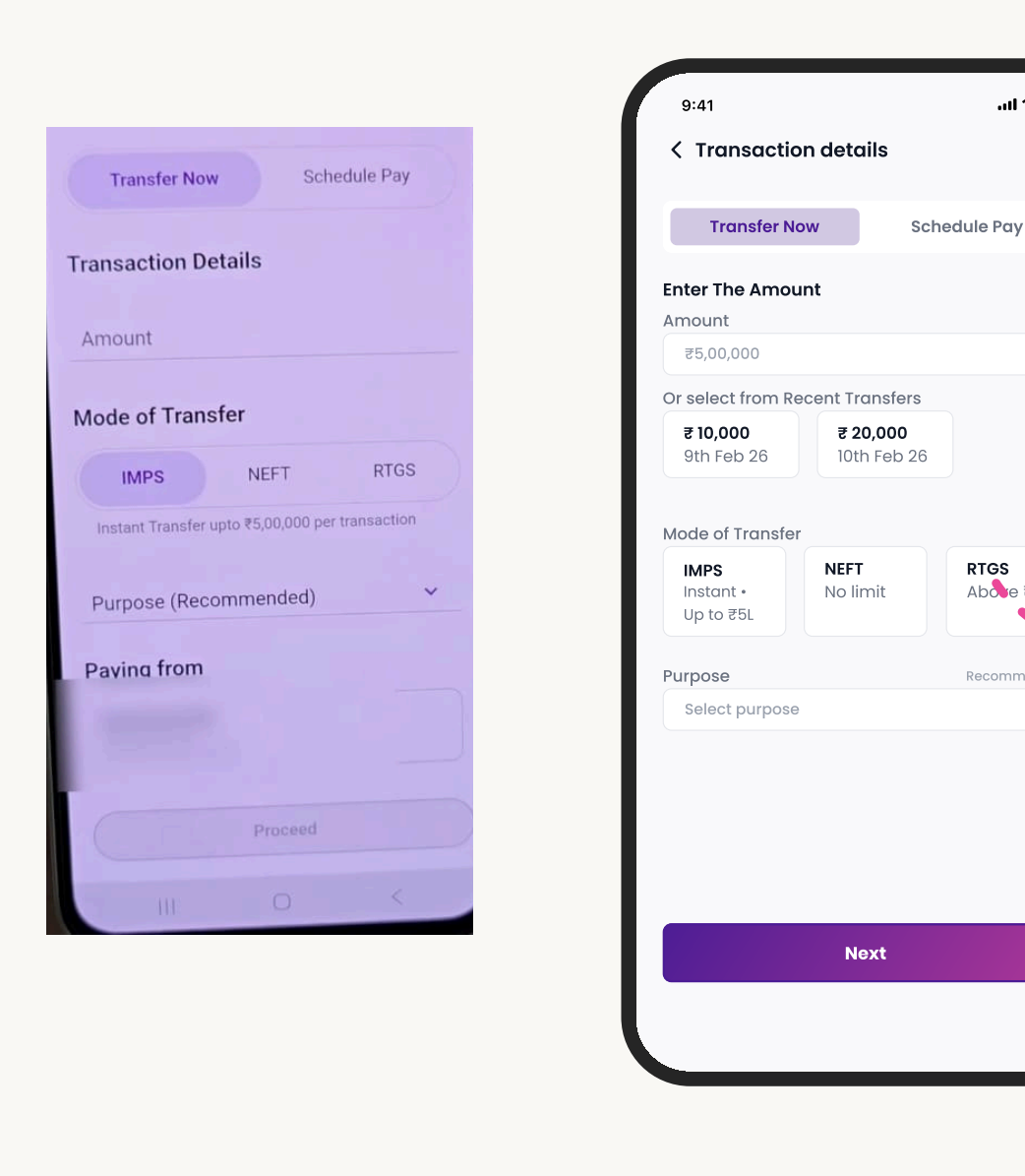
Transfer Money to New Added Payee


Recently added payees were not highlighted

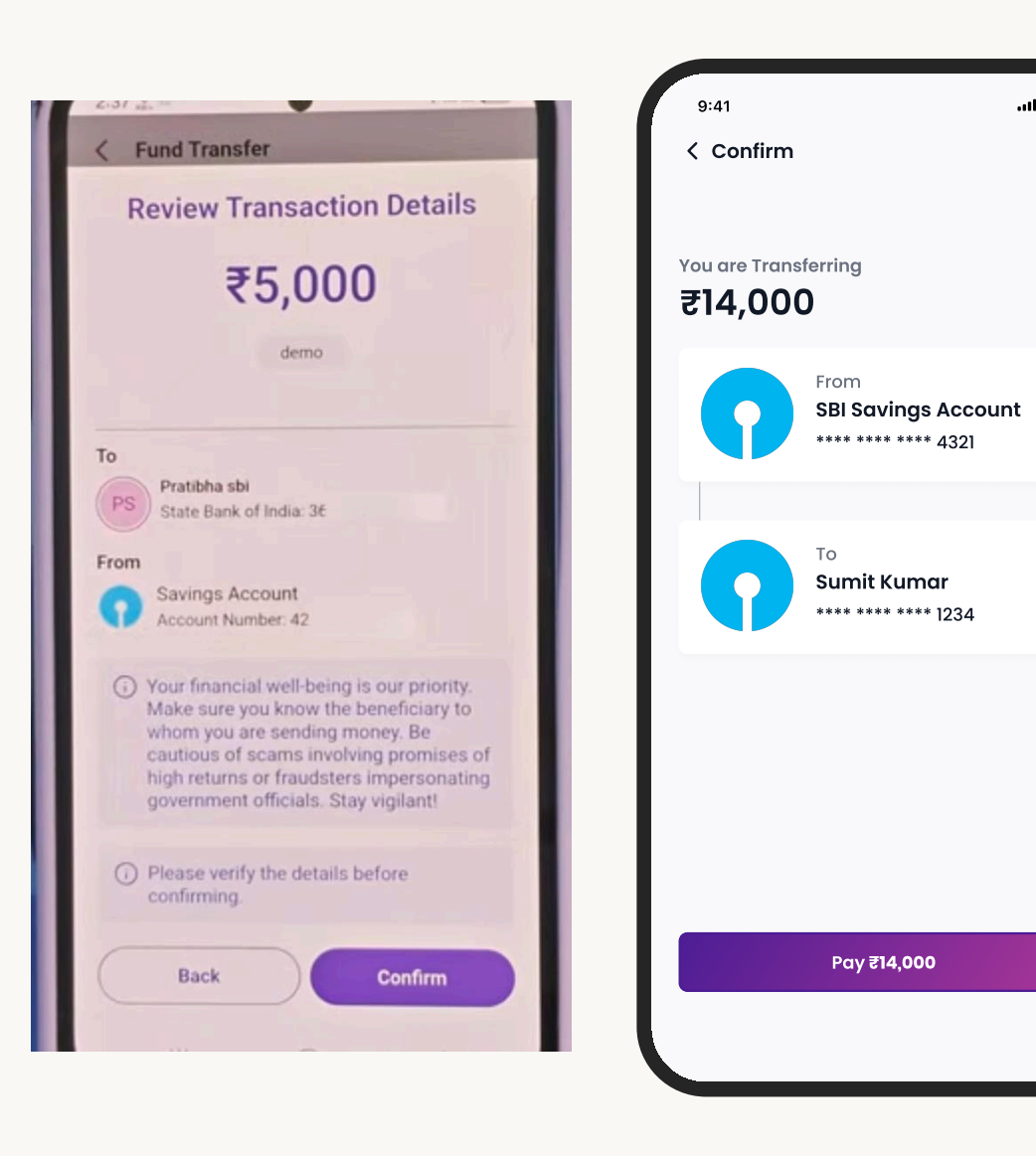
Introduced a confirmation popup before initiating payment **to prevent errors**

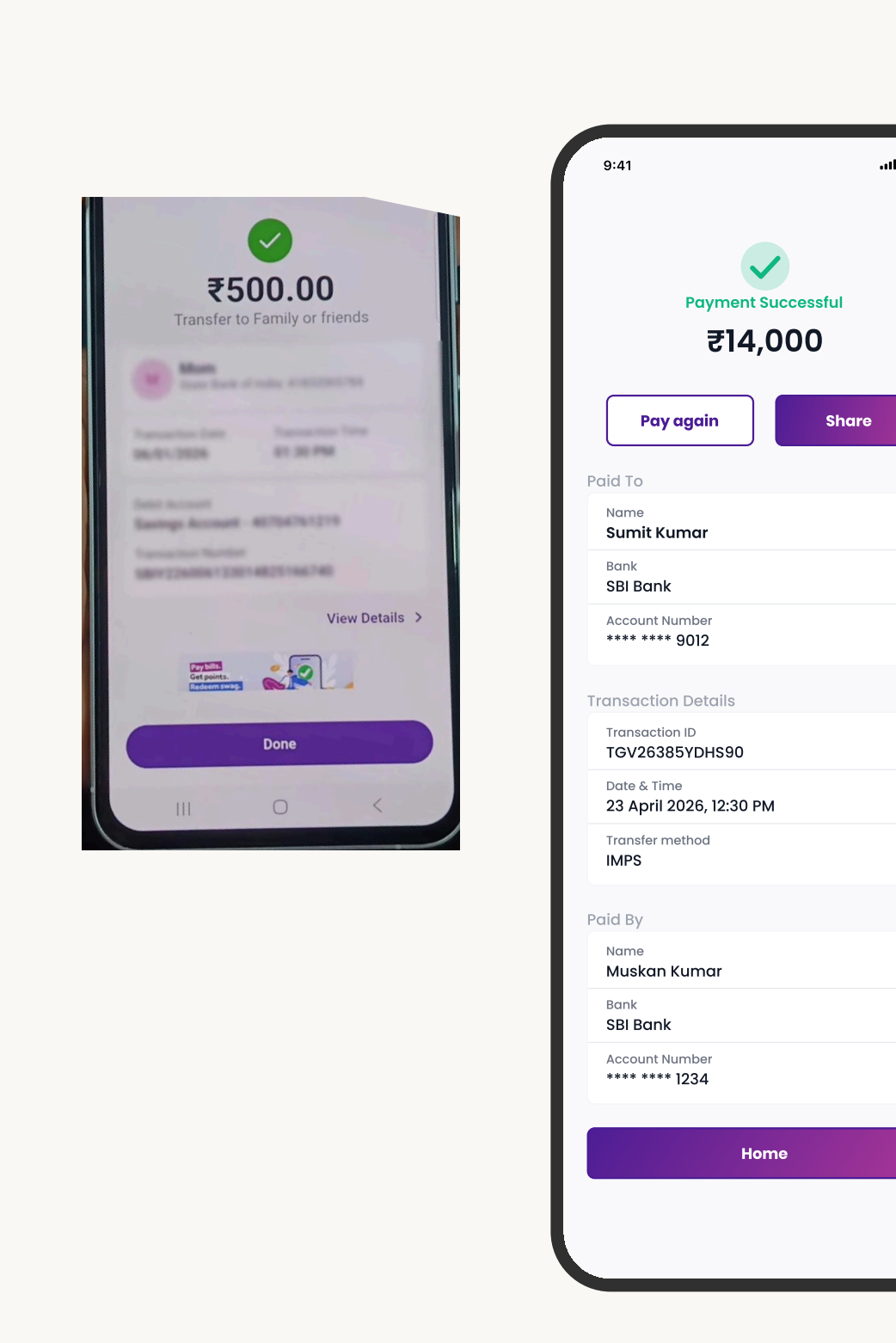
And ensure users verify the selected payee before proceeding.

Fund Transfer
Send money
Quick transfer
Domestic Fund Transfer
Search Payee
Self Transfer
Axis Bank
Recently Added
Sumit Kumar
Pay
Other Payees
Aryan Patil
Aayush Singh
Bharat Shah
Bharti Raut
Add Payee
Schedule
Pay Now


Added information for each transfer mode (IMPS, NEFT, RTGS), displaying their respective limits to reduce the need for users to recall or look up transfer rules before selection

Transaction details
Transfer Now
Schedule Pay
Enter The Amount
₹10,000
₹20,000
Mode of Transfer
IMPS
NEFT
RTGS
Purpose
Next


Review Transaction Details
₹5,000
Back
Confirm
Confirm
You are Transferring
₹14,000
SBI Savings Account
Sumit Kumar
Pay ₹14,000


Consolidated all transaction details onto a single screen to reduce navigation and clicks.

Positioned the "Home" button at the bottom, making it accessible after users review the details through scrolling.

₹500.00
Done
Payment Successful
₹14,000
Pay again
Share
Home

A/B Testing insights

		Complition rate	Error clicks	Avg. Time taken	Satisfaction rate
Task 1	Before	85%	2+	30s to 1 min	3.1 out of 5
	After	100%	0	Less than 10s	4.7 out of 5
Task 2	Before	100% (difficulty)	6+	3 to 6 mins	2.5 out of 5
	After	100%	0	1 to 1.5 mins	4.4 out of 5
Task 3	Before	100%	0	1 min	3.0 out of 5
	After	100%	0	50s to 1 min	4.5 out of 5

CASE CLOSED.